Hydroelectric Energy

Chapter 6 Unit 2 Guided Notes · Grade 4 Using Natural Resources for Energy

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

BIG QUESTION **How do people use moving water as a source of energy?**

KEY WORDS

hydroelectric power — electricity made from the energy of _____ water, usually through a dam.

reservoir — a large area of _____ held behind a dam.

ELECTRICITY PATHWAY

WATER IN A RESERVOIR

↓

FLOWS THROUGH THE DAM

↓

SPINS A TURBINE

↓

TURNS A GENERATOR

↓

ELECTRICITY

CHECK YOUR THINKING

What makes the water move through the turbine?

Benefits and Limitations

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

BENEFITS AND LIMITATIONS

BENEFIT	LIMITATION
renewable (water keeps flowing)	
more predictable (water can be stored)	
floods land behind the dam	
can block fish such as salmon	

CARING FOR RIVERS

Dams can change a river and the habitats around it. Fish ladders help fish move past a dam.

A fish _____ helps salmon move up and down the river.

DRAW / LABEL

Draw a dam. Label the reservoir, turbine, and generator.

draw a dam and label the parts here

CHECK YOUR THINKING

What is one way engineers reduce the harm a dam can cause?

CONNECT *Chapter 6 connection: moving water spins a turbine, just like wind — but water can be stored, making it more predictable.*